his love for me—to take forceful action and change the situation [that had caused so much anguish for me and the administration]. I was deeply touched." What a lucky father I am, I thought.

In my speech to the nation on March 4, 1987, I accepted full responsibility for the Iran-Contra affair and then added: "What should happen when you make a mistake is this: You take your knocks, you learn your lessons, and then you move on."

Howard Baker went on to become an outstanding chief of staff, a perfect man for the job—smart, fair, personable, savvy about Washington, a decent man. And Frank Carlucci and Colin Powell went on to revitalize and restore honor to the NSC.

The cloud that descended over my credibility during the Iran-Contra affair undoubtedly affected the fate of some of my legislative goals during my last two years in office. With the Democrats controlling both houses of Congress, it's hard to say how much more we might have accomplished if the crisis hadn't occurred, but clearly it had some impact. Still, we were able to move on once the Tower Board had removed the cloud from over the White House and agreed, as did the congressional investigating committees, with what I had been saying from the beginning: that I had had no knowledge of any diversion of monies to the Contras.

To this day I still believe that the Iran initiative was *not* an effort to swap arms for hostages. But I know it may not look that way to some people.

I still believe that the policy that led us to attempt to open up a channel to moderate Iranians wasn't wrong. Nevertheless, as I said in my speech when the Tower report was made public, mistakes were made in the implementation of this policy. Because I was so concerned with getting the hostages home, I may not have asked enough questions about how the Iranian initiative was being